

should pay attention to what you put in your Meta tag. It looks something like this:

A Description Meta:

META NAME= "description" content= "Insert site description here, preferably less than 250 characters long."

A Keywords Meta:

META NAME= "keywords" content= "keyphrase 1, keyphrase 2, keyphrase 3, etc."

Another place you could put your keywords is in the "ALT" attribute for images. The HTML code for image placement looks like this:

<IMG SRC= "myImage.gif" width= "10" height= "10" alt= "This is text that appears as a tooltip, or in place of the image if it isn't loaded by the site. Good place for keywords."

Finally, make sure that your pages have at least 200 words of content, with your most important keywords used often (not often enough to turn the content into nonsense, though).

This site sucks!

Forgive us. We've neglected to mention that optimising your site for typos might actually involve you putting those typos in your site text. "What?" you might ask, "Pollute my site with crude grammar?" So this is the first hiccup. How do we work in these typos into our site without looking like a shabby, unprofessional company?

Well, we don't. Obviously, we won't advise you to look silly with the word "plubishing" running around your DTP company's site. We turn to the Meta tags to aid us here; yes, search engines today do use more complex methods to index sites, but the good ole Meta isn't dead yet. If your site's keywords aren't among the most popular terms searched for on the Net, you might be able to get away with just this tactic. Unless, of course, too many other sites thought of the same thing.

The next option is a little better, but is a slightly bitter pill—you need to put the typo in your text. Don't just throw it in anywhere, though. You need to plan it so that the likelihood of it ever being discovered is minimised. Obvious typos convey the impression of being unprofessional, and can be a huge turn-off for many. However, putting it in the page footer or the "ALT" text for an image is somewhat forgivable. You could also change the font colour so it's nearly invisible. We only recommend this approach in case of emergency—if the keyword you're looking to employ is extremely popular and you get no results from the Meta option above.

Why you little \$#@%#!

It isn't difficult to guess that this is a pretty offbeat strategy—which, like all offbeat strategies, is quite likely to be met with accusations of trickery and debauchery. Taking advantage of people's typos like that? Blasphemy!

Or just smart business? Honestly, ask yourself—how many times have you wanted to type in "the", and ended up typing "teh"? Or how many times you've wondered whether it's "independance" or "independence"? (It's the first, by the way) Let's face it—nobody's perfect. Optimising your site for typos not only gives you the added

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advantage of being higher on a search list, it's also great for the customer. "Cool!" he/she would say, "I got what I wanted in spite of my silly mistake!"

There are some things you need to keep in mind before you go ahead, now.

First, look through the keywords you've decided on. Are any of the important ones easy to mess up? Long words usually are. Ditto for words with the 'ie' combination—"Is it 'ie' or 'ei'?" It's a mystery. The point is, don't bother optimising your site for words that, in all likelihood, will not be misspelled.

Second—and very important—make sure that the typos you optimise for are relevant. Nobody's going to like it if your hardware dealership site turns up on a search for "flowers". To see such skulduggery in action, type "weblogs" (an easy typo to make when looking for "weblogs") into Google, and take a look at the fourth result—it directs you to a site that sells prescription drugs!

Third, don't go overboard—under any circumstances, do not let the typos on your site be obvious. Remember, what you want customers to think is that your site is smart enough to know what he's looking for, not that you're trying everything to draw him in. For a taste of some good old desperation, type "kasinop" (you might end up with this when looking for "kasino") into Google, click on the very first result. It looks quite harmless initially; but scroll down, and the story is a tad different.

Finally, as far as possible, try to restrict the typos to the Meta tags.



Just your regular, run of the mill Indian Gambling Site



Aargh! Half a page of typos! There's no escaping this site!

Stand Fast

With some careful thought, you could considerably boost your business with little or no additional cost. It is important, though, to keep your ear to the ground—any hint of a negative response entails another look at your strategy.

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nimish_chandiramani@thinkdigit.com